CODEALPHA CYBER SECURITY INTERNSHIP

Phishing Awareness Training

How to spot, avoid and report phishing

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What is phishing?

A scam where attackers pretend to be someone you trust, to steal passwords, money or personal data.

1. Pretend

Looks like a bank, boss or known brand

2. Pressure

Creates fear or urgency

3. Steal

You click, reply or share details

Common types of phishing

Email phishing

Fake emails with bad links or attachments

SMS (smishing)

Text messages with fake alerts and links

Voice (vishing)

Phone calls pretending to be your bank

Fake websites

Copies of real login pages that steal passwords

Red flags in an email

- Urgent threats ("act in 24 hours")
- Sender address that looks slightly wrong
- Generic greeting like "Dear customer"
- Links that do not match the real website
- Unexpected attachments or requests for passwords

Check the link before you click

REAL

https://yourbank.com/login

FAKE

https://yourbank-secure-login.com

Hover over a link to see where it really goes. Look at the domain right before .com

Spot the phishing email

From: support@yourbank-alerts.com

URGENT: Account suspended

Dear customer, we noticed unusual activity. Verify within 24 hours or your account will be closed. Click here: bit.ly/verify-now

- **Wrong sender domain**
- **Urgent threat**
- **Generic greeting**
- **Shortened link**

If you get a suspicious message

1. Stop

Do not click, reply or open attachments

2. Report

Tell your IT team or use the report phishing button

3. Delete

Remove it from your inbox

If you already clicked

1. Disconnect from the internet
2. Change the password you may have shared
3. Turn on two-factor authentication (2FA)
4. Tell your IT team or your bank
5. Watch your accounts for strange activity

Quick quiz

Question	Answer
Email says your account closes in 1 hour. Real?	Likely phishing. Urgency is a red flag.
Sender is support@bank-secure.com. Safe?	Not sure. Check the real bank domain.
You clicked a bad link. First step?	Disconnect, then change passwords.

Key takeaways

- Stop and think before you click
- Check the sender and the link
- Report it, then delete it
- Use 2FA on every account